Hycient Igweze

Senior Full-Stack & ML Engineer
London, UK | +44 7438 151740 | igwezehycient86@gmail.com | LinkedIn | GitHub | hycient.dev

PROFILE SUMMARY

- Full-stack and ML engineer with ~a decade of experience building production systems across fintech, payments, health and government, for companies in Africa, Europe and the Middle East.
- At Whiteshield, part of the teams behind UAE Skills and EduHub, national platforms for the UAE government; wrote the skills and course recommendation model for UAE Skills.
- Built payment infrastructure for PayS ($30M+ processed monthly, 500,000+ active users) and led mobile engineering for a multi-currency crypto exchange.
- Design AI systems where the model proposes and deterministic code decides, and evaluate ML models with leakage-safe splits and honest metrics.

CORE COMPETENCIES

System Architecture & Scalability · AI/LLM Product Engineering · ML Pipelines & Model Evaluation · API Design · Payments & Fintech Systems · Workflow Automation · Technical Leadership & Mentoring · Stakeholder Management

TOOLS AND TECHNOLOGIES

- **Languages:** TypeScript, JavaScript, C#, Python, Dart
- **Frontend & Mobile:** React, Next.js, React Native, Flutter, Tailwind CSS
- **Backend & Data:** Node.js, NestJS, .NET, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Prisma, GraphQL
- **AI & ML:** LLM agents (LangGraph, Claude API, ChatGPT API, Zod structured outputs), embeddings, recommendation models, scikit-learn, TensorFlow/Keras, NumPy, joblib, data pipelines, leakage-safe evaluation
- **Cloud & Delivery:** AWS, Azure, Railway, Cloudflare, CI/CD, TDD

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer – Whiteshield Group | Remote **Jan. 2025 – Present**

- Build AI-powered national platforms for UAE government clients as part of Whiteshield's delivery teams, using Next.js, TypeScript and .NET (C#).
- **UAE Skills** (MoHRE & MoHESR): worked across the full platform, a web, iOS and Android service linking labour-market demand, graduate outcomes and enrolment, and wrote the skills and course recommendation model behind the student experience.
- **EduHub** (MoHESR): part of the team that developed the national admissions and scholarship portal, with 74 institutions registered; its AI-enhanced scholarship flow cut applications from 22 form fields to four.
- Engineered an AI-driven job listing and candidate-matching system, cutting job description drafting time by about 70%.
- Collaborate with policy and economics teams across 4 continents to turn strategy into production software that meets public-sector QA standards.

Software Engineer – Sahara Group | Remote **Oct. 2023 – Sept. 2025**

- Built core services for PayS, an energy and utility payments platform whose largest client is Ikeja Electric, processing $30M+ monthly for 500,000+ active users.
- Developed the receipt service behind every transaction on the platform (payment, e-bill and bulk payment receipts) and the customer portal for power bills and meter payments.
- Developed a mini in-house Content Delivery Network (CDN) using AWS S3, Node.js, TypeScript and Handlebars, shared across products within the group.
- Led the development of the PayS Store multi-vendor marketplace (1,000+ vendors) and the Flutter mobile app for electricity tokens, airtime and bills.

Lead Mobile App Engineer – Cloud P2P | Remote **Aug. 2022 – Oct. 2023**

- Led a team of mobile engineers to ship 2 major versions of a peer-to-peer crypto trading platform, with multi-currency and cross-chain trading, escrowed trades, ratings and dispute resolution.
- Shaped the app architecture and business logic, and raised code quality through rigorous code reviews and a structured release process.

Lead Frontend Engineer – Pluralcode | Remote **May 2022 – Jul. 2023**

- Developed and managed a Learning Management System supporting 10,000+ monthly users, and maintained the ACHAN (Airport Car-Hire Association of Nigeria) booking system for 3,000+ customers and providers.
- Developed an optician's e-commerce API in Node.js integrated with a React frontend, and mentored cohorts of new engineers in JavaScript and React.

Freelance & Contract Engineer – Remote **2018 – 2022**

- Node.js commerce APIs (Wetfire), a React e-commerce platform (Adehot), React Native fintech apps (Vision Savings, Tranxnow), DeFi lending flows (Vilo), a reusable component library (Groomlog) and iOS telehealth apps for patients and doctors (myhealthXP).

SELECTED PROJECTS

Handshake Agent (LLM Payments Agent) *NestJS, Next.js, LangGraph, Claude, Prisma, PostgreSQL*

- Chat-native crypto and payments agent where the LLM cannot move money: its only output is a validated Zod intent with no destination field, and a deterministic engine re-derives every amount, re-runs KYC, velocity and sanctions checks at settlement, and executes only with a PIN and a single-use HMAC grant on a BigInt double-entry ledger. About 78 lines of LLM code against 3,000 of engine. Write-up | Code

Credit Scoring on African Loan Data *scikit-learn, TensorFlow/Keras*

- 68,000 loans with a 1.8% default rate; customer-grouped splits, history features built only from earlier loans, and PR-AUC instead of accuracy. A tuned Random Forest (PR-AUC 0.936, 92% recall at 77% precision) beat a wide & deep network, with the gap confirmed by a customer-level bootstrap. Article

Malaria Detection CNN *TensorFlow/Keras, MobileNetV2*

- Lightweight blood-smear classifier split by source image to prevent leakage: 95.6% sensitivity, 96.5% specificity and 0.991 ROC-AUC on 4,105 held-out cells. Article

Multimodal Identity & Recommendation Pipeline *Python*

- Built the execution layer that chains face recognition, voice verification and product recommendation models into one gated flow (team project). Code

NexusWait (Waitlist SaaS) *React, Vite, Tailwind CSS*

- Waitlist platform with hosted pages, form integrations (Mailchimp, Slack, HubSpot, Zapier and more) and a REST API with SDKs. nexuswait.com

VENTURES

- **PlumAutomate** – Founder, software and automation studio. Work includes the Zentry ticket marketplace (web, iOS and Android; 10,000+ users and 100,000+ tickets in its first year), a cross-border settlement API for Handshake, and Blimdata's medical-imaging pipeline (PACS gateway, DICOM de-identification, radiologist annotation). plumautomate.com
- **Moving Man Logistics** – Co-founder & CEO, on-demand delivery and rides in Kigali, Rwanda.
- **EcoRed** – Co-founder, SON-certified low-carbon laterite cement and bricks for affordable housing in Nigeria.

EDUCATION & SPEAKING

- **African Leadership University** – BSc, Machine Learning & Computer Science
- **Guest Speaker** – University of Greenwich International College (2026): "What it means to be an engineer when AI can write the code", delivered to the new international engineering intake.